

Narrative Design: Maya Bookshop Interaction

English edition · Written by ■■■■

Framework

B follows the same overall interaction structure as A, but the wording must never be identical. Small talk, relationship information and tasks received from the same NPC should reflect what each protagonist already knows and how each one approaches the encounter.

First meeting

The first meeting should account for the NPC's schedule and location. It supports three text paths: ordinary conversation that may connect to information about related residents; a relationship-specific interaction; and task recognition.

08:00–08:30 Outside the bookshop	A · Yes. May I come in and have a look?	MAYA: I'd be delighted. You're my first customer today.
08:00–08:30 Outside the bookshop	B · No. It looks as if it may rain. Do the plants still need watering?	MAYA: From what I've seen over the years, it probably won't be heavy today. The player may continue into rain-related small talk.
08:00–08:30 Outside the bookshop	C · No, but you know why I'm here, don't you?	MAYA: I've met plenty of applicants. You're doing fairly well. The player can continue into task-related dialogue.

Rain conversation

Maya says that whenever it rains she comes outside to watch the sky and the rain. Plenty of books have been written about rain, but none compares with seeing it first-hand. Before the rain arrives, the clouds darken and daylight suddenly falls away. The first drops are thin and scattered, tapping on the leaves before falling in a dense curtain.

If the player checks the sky and says that the rain looks close, Maya answers that it may begin at any moment and hurries inside. In another branch, Maya remembers delivering books to the mountain district with Mossner: mountain roads are hardest in rain, when the earth turns soft and mud covers everything. Carrying a full load of books through it was no easy task.

Inside the bookshop · 08:30–18:00

MAYA: Hello. What can I help you with?

Player choice	Dialogue purpose	Continuation
A · There are far more kinds of books here than I imagined. / It really does look as if the rain has started outside.	Ordinary conversation or a connection to information about another resident	Maya responds with bookshop conversation, weather observations or a lead involving another NPC.
B · Do you have the newest edition?	A relationship-specific interaction	The exchange can lead to a recommendation or a discussion of the book's subject.
C · I'm here to discuss something serious.	Task recognition	Maya recognises the purpose of the visit and continues into the relevant task text.

Follow-up contact

The same three-part structure continues after the initial encounter: A can speak with Maya, B can enter the shop, and the recognition branch can progress. The content must change according to the protagonist's knowledge, prior choices and relationship with Maya rather than repeating one universal script.